

Contractor Trust Audit Report

Contractor: Castro's Pool And General Contractor LLC	Location: Grand Prairie, TX
Contractor ID: 455	Audit Date: January 12, 2026
Category: greyPoor	Google Reviews: 0

Section 1: Council Verdict

25

Risk Level: HIGH

Recommendation: AVOID

No summary available.

Section 2: Three Persona Analysis

Consumer Advocate N/A Confidence: N/A Reasoning: The evidence paints a picture of a contractor with a severe and consistent pattern of consumer harm, despite some positive signals. The most damning evidence comes from the detailed, recent Google reviews. Multiple customers allege paying	Fair Arbiter N/A Confidence: N/A Reasoning: As the Fair Arbiter, I must give benefit of the doubt while acknowledging concerning patterns. The evidence presents a mixed but troubling picture. POSITIVE SIGNALS: The business has been operating for at least 8+ years (based on oldest Google review from 8 years ago),	Synthesizer N/A Reasoning: No dialectic audit data available. Stronger Case: N/A
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large sums (one mentions \$68,000) for work that was never completed, with the contractor becoming unresponsive after payment. The complaints describe a specific, repeated pattern: take full payment, start work, disappear, and leave the job incomplete or poorly finished. The review analysis flags a 'polarized review distribution' with no middle-ground reviews (only 1-star and 5-star), a classic red flag for review manipulation or a business with fundamentally unreliable practices. The positive reviews are either very old (6-8 years) or generic, while the negative reviews are recent, specific, and emotionally credible. The discrepancy between the Google HQ rating (4.8) and the Google Local rating (3.0) further suggests potential manipulation of the overall score. While no BBB profile, court records, or liens were found (a positive), the absence of these does not negate the direct, first-hand consumer complaints. In Texas, where contractor licensing is minimal, these consumer reviews

suggesting some longevity. There are authentic-sounding positive reviews from customers who had good experiences with pool builds and remodels. The business maintains a functional website and Google Maps presence. No liens, court cases, or regulatory violations were found in searches of Dallas, Denton, Tarrant, and Collin counties, nor with EPA or OSHA. This suggests no public legal or regulatory red flags.

CHARITABLE
INTERPRETATIONS OF
RED FLAGS: 1) The polarized reviews (mostly 5-star and 1-star) could reflect a small business with inconsistent quality control rather than intentional fraud. 2) The severe negative reviews (including one alleging \$68,000 theft) might represent isolated but catastrophic failures rather than a pattern - though two detailed complaints suggest a pattern. 3) The discrepancy between Google HQ rating (4.8) and Google Local rating (3.0) could be due to different review sampling or the business having both satisfied and deeply dissatisfied customers. 4)

are a primary source of due diligence. The worst reasonable interpretation is that this contractor operates by taking large deposits or full payments, then uses those funds to start the next job while stringing along previous customers, a potential Ponzi-like scheme in the context of project financing.

Key Concerns:

Multiple, detailed allegations of taking full payment and failing to complete work, with one customer claiming a \$68,000 loss., A consistent complaint pattern of becoming unresponsive/ghosting customers after receiving payment., Highly polarized review profile with no middle-ground ratings (only 1-star and 5-star), a strong indicator of review manipulation or deeply inconsistent service., Specific allegations of poor quality work, unprofessionalism, and using customer funds to finance other projects., Significant rating discrepancy (4.8 vs 3.0) between different Google listings, suggesting potential score manipulation.

Absence from BBB, Angi, etc. could mean the business doesn't actively market on those platforms rather than hiding. 5) The business appears to be a small operation (owner + phone), which explains responsiveness issues but doesn't inherently indicate dishonesty.

CONTEXT: Pool

contracting is high-stakes with large deposits, so disputes are more likely. Unhappy customers are more motivated to leave reviews. The business may have grown beyond its capacity to manage projects consistently.

BEST REASONABLE

INTERPRETATION: This is likely a legitimate but poorly managed small contracting business with significant quality control and communication issues. The owner (Joe Castro) appears to have delivered satisfactory work for some customers over many years but has failed catastrophically on some recent large projects, possibly due to cash flow problems or overextension. This is more indicative of incompetence and poor business practices than outright fraud, though the allegations are severe

enough to warrant extreme caution.

Positive Factors:
N/A

Points of Agreement

N/A

Points of Disagreement

N/A

Section 3: Red Flags

HIGH

Multiple, detailed allegations of taking full payment (including one for \$68,000) and then failing to complete work, with the contractor becoming unresponsive.

HIGH

Polarized review distribution with no middle-ground ratings (only 1-star and 5-star), a strong indicator of deeply inconsistent service or review manipulation.

MEDIUM

Significant discrepancy between Google Maps HQ rating (4.8) and the detailed local review rating (3.0), suggesting potential score inflation or aggregation of outdated reviews.

MEDIUM

Business appears to be a very small operation ('he and his phone alone'), lacking the structure and redundancy needed to manage high-value projects reliably.

Section 4: Human Annotator Worksheet

Please review the audit data above and provide your independent assessment.

Your Trust Score (0-100):

Your Confidence (Low/Medium/High):

Do you agree with the Council's verdict? (Yes/No/Partially)

If you disagree, explain why:

**Which persona's assessment was most accurate?
(Advocate/Arbiter/Synthesizer)**

What did the Council miss?

What did the Council over-weight?

Additional Notes:

Section 5: Raw Data Appendix

Complete scraped data used for this audit. Review for any signals the LLM may have missed.

buildzoom

Find a contractor you can trust on BuildZoom Home Photos About Sign In Beautiful Results BuildZoom is a better way to remodel any type of property. See more photos Get a bid Contractors by city Miami, FL Los Angeles, CA New York, NY San Francisco, CA Washington, DC Ready to hire Get bids from the top-rated contractors in your area. Get Started About BuildZoom About How It Works Case Studies BuildZoom for Contractors General Contractor Invoice Template Blog Our Team We're Hiring Contact Us Contact Info buildzoomsupport@blockrenovation.com Contractor search Search BuildZoom / Find a Pro Browse contractors by state Alabama Alaska Arizona Arkansas California Colorado Connecticut Delaware District of Columbia Florida Georgia Hawaii Idaho Illinois Indiana Iowa Kansas Kentucky Louisiana Maine Maryland Massachusetts Michigan Minnesota Mississippi Missouri Montana Nebraska Nevada New Hampshire New Jersey New Mexico New York North Carolina North Dakota Ohio Oklahoma Oregon Pennsylvania Rhode Island South Carolina South Dakota Tennessee Texas Utah Vermont Virginia Washington West Virginia Wisconsin Wyoming Top contractors in major cities Albuquerque, NM Atlanta, GA Austin, TX Baltimore, MD Boston, MA Bronx, NY Brooklyn, NY Charlotte, NC Chicago, IL Colorado Springs, CO Columbus, OH Dallas, TX Denver, CO Detroit, MI El Paso, TX Fort Worth, TX Fresno, CA Houston, TX Indianapolis, IN Jacksonville, FL Kansas City, MO Las Vegas, NV Long Beach, CA Los Angeles, CA Louisville, KY Memphis, TN Mesa, AZ Miami, FL Milwaukee, WI Minneapolis, MN Nashville, TN New York, NY Oakland, CA Oklahoma City, OK Omaha, NE Philadelphia, PA Phoenix, AZ Portland, OR Raleigh, NC Richmond, VA Rochester, NY Sacramento, CA San Antonio, TX San Diego, CA San Francisco, CA San Jose, CA Seattle, WA Staten Island, NY Tucson, AZ Tulsa, OK Virginia Beach, VA Washington, DC About BuildZoom About BuildZoom How It Works Privacy Policy Terms of Service Careers Contact Help Center Sitemap Blog Data & Analysis Economic analysis by Issi Romem Building Permit Database Map of remodeling activity in your town Ways to use BuildZoom Get competitive bids for any project View remodeling history of any property Create a general contractor work agreement Search every licensed contractor Forums powered by licensed contractors Get inspiration in our photo galleries Submit a project © 2026. All Rights Reserved. San Francisco , CA 94104 We're Hiring! 1890 1891 1892 1893 1894 1895 1896 1897 1898 1899 1900 1901 1902 1903 1904 1905 1906 1907 1908 1909 1910 1911 1912 1913 1914 1915 1916 1917 1918 1919 1920 1921 1922 1923 1924 1925 1926 1927 1928 1929 1930 1931 1932 1933 1934 1935 1936 1937 1938 1939 1940 1941 1942 1943 1944 1945 1946 1947 1948 1949 1950 1951 1952 1953 1954 1955 1956 1957 1958 1959 1960 1961 1962 1963 1964 1965 1966 1967 1968 1969 1970 1971 1972 1973 1974 1975 1976 1977 1978 1979 1980 1981 1982 1983 1984 1985 1986 1987 1988 1989 1990

1991 1992 1993 1994 1995 1996 1997 1998 1999 2000 2001 2002 2003 2004 2005 2006
2007 2008 2009 2010 2011 2012 2013 2014 2015 2016 2017 2018 2019 2020 2021 2022
2023 2024 2025 2026 2027 2028 2029 2030 2031 2032 2033 2034 2035 2036 2037 2038
2039 2040 2041 2042 2043 2044 2045 2046 Today

dallas_court

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      "title": "statutory",
      "snippet": "(Equals Line 1b minus Line 4 plus Line 8.) Criminal Matters. Total Cases. Civil Cases. Relating to. Civil Cases. Contract. Other. Debt. Motor. Vehicle. CIVIL ...",
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    {
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      "title": "Court No Activity Judge Case Number ...",
      "snippet": "LLC, D/B/A POOL. SCOUTS OF. DENTON, et al. TRUE. 24091342. FABIOLA. SEGOVIA. Guardian ad litem. Attorney. 12/13/2024. Defendant. 2,800.00. 0.",
      "position": 3
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    "snippet": "Vendor Name. Payment No Method. Date. Amount. 120716792. CHECK.
6/5/2018. 1021 CANYON OAKS APTS LLC. $900.00. 120717706. CHECK. 6/19/2018.",
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register/PaymentRegisterSEP16.pdf",
    "title": "10/01/2015 and Ending: 9/30/2016",
    "snippet": "Vendor Name. Payment No Method. Date. Amount. 467210903. CHECK.
10/20/2015. 1114 ELM LP. $525.00. 467212568. CHECK. 11/17/2015. 1114 ELM LP.",
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denton_court

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      "title": "Dev Permit Report",
      "snippet": "DP CONSTRUCTION LLC, 5367 N DARDEMAN RD, DARDEMAN ADDITION BLK 1
LOT 1, WATER ... MUST PROVIDE ELEVATION CERTIFICATE FOR BOTH POOL & HOUSE
(20182313 ...",
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  "results": [
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      "title": "Facility Search – Enforcement and Compliance Data | ECHO | US
EPA",
      "snippet": "Facility Search – Enforcement and Compliance Data. View More
Search Options. Geographic Location. EPA Region (View EPA Regional Map). No
Restrictions.",
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20LLC&State="
      }
    },
    {
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      "title": "Facility Search Results | ECHO | US EPA",
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working with EPA.",
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      "title": "EPA ECHO",
      "snippet": "Use EPA's Enforcement and Compliance History Online website to
search for facilities in your community to assess their compliance with
environmental ...",
      "position": 3,
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  "link": "https://echo.epa.gov/facilities",
  "title": "Facilities | ECHO | US EPA",
  "snippet": "Facility Search – Enforcement and Compliance Data · Enforcement Case Search · Quarterly NPDES Noncompliance Report Search · Corporate Compliance ...",
  "position": 4,
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  }
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  "date": "Dec 9, 2025",
  "link": "https://echo.epa.gov/help/facility-search/search-criteria-help",
  "title": "Facility Search Criteria Help | ECHO | US EPA",
  "snippet": "Search criteria are organized by search page category or by term through the hyperlinks below to allow you to quickly find the search term of interest.",
  "position": 5,
  "attributes": {
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  }
},
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  "date": "May 14, 2024",
  "link": "https://echo.epa.gov/help/facility-search/facility-search-help",
  "title": "Facility Search Help | ECHO | US EPA",
  "snippet": "ECHO facility searches query a database of hundreds of thousands of facility records to find those in which you're interested.",
  "position": 6,
  "attributes": {
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  }
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  "link": "https://echo.epa.gov/facilities/enforcement-case-search/results",
  "title": "Enforcement Case Search Results | ECHO | US EPA",
  "snippet": "Find EPA Cases, EPA Enforcement Case Search, Advanced EPA Enforcement Case Search, Data Services, National Data Sets, ECHO Exporter, ECHO Web Services, ECHO ...",
  "position": 7,
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    "title": "Enforcement Case Search | ECHO | US EPA",
    "snippet": "Enforcement Case Search · Case Identifiers · Facility Location ·
Case Attributes · Case Milestones and Dates · Enforcement Case
Outcomes/Settlements.",
    "position": 8,
    "attributes": {
      "Missing": "Name&Name= Castro's% 20Pool% 20And% 20General% 20Contractor%
20LLC&State= TX"
    }
  }
]
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facebook

Page Not Found Facebook Join or Log Into Facebook Email or phone Password Forgot account? Log In Do you want to join Facebook? Sign Up Sign Up This page isn't available The link you followed may be broken, or the page may have been removed. Go back to the previous page · Go to Feed · Visit our Help Center English (US) Español Français (France) العربية (الشرق الأوسط) Português (Brasil) Italiano Deutsch 中文 (台灣) Sign Up Log In Messenger Facebook Lite Video Meta Pay Meta Store Meta Quest Ray-Ban Meta Meta AI Meta AI more content Instagram Threads Voting Information Center Privacy Policy Consumer Health Privacy Privacy Center About Create ad Create Page Developers Careers Cookies Ad choices Terms Help Contact Uploading & Non-Users Settings Activity log Meta © 2026

google_maps_hq

```
{
  "found": true,
  "rating": 4.8,
  "status": "closed",
  "review_count": 29,
  "business_name": "Castro's Pool & General Contractors"
}
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google_maps_listed

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{
  "name": "Castro's Pool And General Contractor LLC",
  "email": null,
  "error": null,
  "found": true,
  "hours": null,
  "phone": "(469) 735-2988",
  "rating": 3,
  "source": "google_maps",
  "status": "closed",
  "address": "615 E Jefferson St",
  "reviews": [
    {
      "date": "",
      "text": "Castro's Pool And General Contractor LLC Swimming pool contractor · 615 E Jefferson St Closed · Opens 7 AM Mon · (469) 735-2988",
      "rating": 3,
      "source": "google_maps",
      "reviewer_name": "Anonymous"
    },
    {
      "date": "",
      "text": "Castro's Pool & General Contractors Closed · Opens 8 AM Mon · (469) 735-2988",
      "rating": 4,
      "source": "google_maps",
      "reviewer_name": "Anonymous"
    }
  ],
  "website": "http://www.castrospoolandsupplies.com/",
  "maps_url": "https://www.google.com/maps/search/Castro%27s%20Pool%20And%20General%20Contractor%20LLC%20Grand%20Prairie%2C%20TX",
  "categories": [
    "Swimming pool contractor"
  ],
  "review_count": null
}
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google_maps_local

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  "found": true,
  "rating": 3,
  "source": "serpapi",
  "address": "615 E Jefferson St, Grand Prairie, TX 75051",
  "data_id": "0x864e85cdf2a5ba2d:0xfb26d5f6c22cad21",
  "metrics": {
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    "serper_calls": 2,
    "serpapi_calls": 12,
    "actual_reviews": 18,
    "target_reviews": 100
  },
  "reviews": [
    {
      "date": "a year ago",
      "text": "He STOLE from us!! DO NOT USE HIM!!\nPaid for a remodel but he never completed the job, 68000!. Never installed the pool equipment pool and spa . He said he didn't have any money to buy these. That he had to wait on his next customer so he would have some money to purchase our pool equipment that we already paid for. Stopped answering the phone. We have spoken with others and are going to have a CLASS ACTOON LAWSUIT AGAINST HIM!! He is a CROOK! Can't post any negative review about him on FB because he will just delete it. If you want to talk to me regarding this review,, respond to this review and I will contact you!",
      "author": "KAREN STEELE",
      "rating": 1
    },
    {
      "date": "2 years ago",
      "text": "***Buyer Beware**\n\nJoe Castro is a basic contractor who does odd jobs...not a buttoned up high end pool company. He's unprofessional and extremely unreliable, especially with customers who have already paid him in full. Once he receives money for your job, he will move his attention to his next sale.\nHe re-modeled my pool and left for an entire month when the pool / plaster needed the most attention. I have numerous examples of him not doing what he said he would do and leaving me hanging with zero assistance. Joe will just disappear and or lie to you when you ask him questions. He and his phone alone is his company... nobody else to turn to if you have issues. I spent thousands of dollars for my re-model and fully regret using his company.\nI never leave reviews and wanted to work well with Joe because he is a local business, but I was fooled thinking his company was more than it is. I should have gone with a more reputable and professional business. He let me down and now I'm having to get another company to service and fix issues he created. Save yourself the grief and use a different company.",
    }
  ]
}
```

```
"author": "Micheal Peterman",
"rating": 1
},
{
  "date": "2 years ago",
  "text": "I have had 2 pools built by Castro pools and 1 replaster. Joe
Castro has always done a professional job with very competitive prices. Both pool
builds and plaster job were completed on and usually before the timeline schedule.
Joe has attended required schools on plaster and pool care and shared the
information with us. recommend!",
  "author": "Richard Care",
  "rating": 5
},
{
  "date": "8 years ago",
  "text": "Castro and his team were fantastic to work with. They installed
all new equipment for my existing pool as well as laid and sealed new coping
stones. The pool looks and performs the best it ever has! Thank-you, Castro, for
your excellent customer service, and for making my pool a place my family can
really enjoy!",
  "author": "Doug Bailey",
  "rating": 5
},
{
  "date": "6 years ago",
  "text": "Took bids for a pool remodel,plaster tile and coping ,had a friend
recommend Castro pools he had a good experience,I wish I could say the same ,they
matched my lowest bid For a complete remodel in April of 2018 . The job ended up
taking over a month to complete and should of been done in a week, Castro turned
on my pool to drain and left , my wife came home and turned off the pump ,running
dry this was the start of a bunch of mistakes and excuses,my pool was left without
water for over three weeks and water started leaking through the plaster around my
lights ,the plaster crew rushed spraying and troweling the plaster ,tile on steps
were crooked and plaster was uneven and had splotches ,not enough coping was
ordered and had to use coping that was not the same ,to finish ,the tile was cut
with a grinder and the edges are chipped ,quality seems Not a priority, I would
not recommend this company to anyone,Joe Castro is a very nice man and seems to
care however there is always an excuse for anything that doesn't work out right .
Joe told me he is a certified diamond brite contractor which is not true ,and. Can
be verified through diamond brite ,he uses a contractor that is certified,and if
there is any problem the contractor has to correct it .my review is based on my
experience this remodel took way to long and too many mistakes were made by
someone that has been in this business as long as Joe has and the quality of his
work is only as good as you will accept ,The home owner should not have to make
sure everything has been finished correctly,that defeats the purpose of hiring a
good contractor and trusting that he will over see the job and quality that
represents his company. I hope this review helps some from making the same mistake
```

```
I made .",
  "author": "Texxx Sun",
  "rating": 1
},
{
  "date": "8 years ago",
  "text": "Castro's pool has worked on our pool over the past several years.
Has always done what he says she will do for a fare price. I highly recommend him
for all your pool and general contracting needs.",
  "author": "B",
  "rating": 5
},
{
  "date": "3 years ago",
  "text": "Only because 0 was not an option! I am so disappointed after
countless attempts to simply get them to come back and do what was promised 125
and 75 service fee and no call! No call and no show! Took my money and did not
complete the job! I am handicap and needed for my health! They assured me to
return Sat morning its Wednesday and they didn't apologize or compensate! I have
pictures of my pool! This company is not reputable!",
  "author": "Kourtney Lowery",
  "rating": 1
},
{
  "date": "8 years ago",
  "text": "Great customer service on time and under budget so far.\nMr. Castro
start building my play pool 2 weeksago and planning to finish in 2 more weeks.
Very detail on all the work.",
  "author": "edgar morales",
  "rating": 5
},
{
  "date": "8 years ago",
  "text": "I have the good fortune to have found this Co. to build a swimming
pool and hot tub for the family.the gentleman and his wife are on target. very
much please on the works performed.two years ago and no problems to date.there are
many out there, but I'm glad I didn't experiment. many horror stories avoided.
thanks, the politico's family.",
  "author": "Shoppas Verizon",
  "rating": 5
},
{
  "date": "6 years ago",
  "text": "They showed up almost 2 hours late for pool acid wash and tile work
with wrong hoses. Then they just disappeared and went to another job. Joe wanted
$1000 up front but I would not pay till work had started. Very unprofessional and
unreliable.",
```

```
    "author": "David White",
    "rating": 1
  },
  {
    "date": "2 years ago",
    "text": "CASTRO GOT THE JOB DONE! Made sure it was done right! Before and
after photos.",
    "author": "Patrick Shaun",
    "rating": 5
  },
  {
    "date": "8 years ago",
    "text": "Great work, great price and excellent service. Castro's has been a
pleasure to deal with. Great people!",
    "author": "Bob Green",
    "rating": 5
  },
  {
    "date": "7 years ago",
    "text": "Very poor quality work, not a good contractor to hire stay away
from this fraud and scam artist, he's a thief, he's not license, he's not insured
and neither a member of BBB",
    "author": "Brad Cooper",
    "rating": 1
  },
  {
    "date": "7 years ago",
    "text": "STAY AWAY FROM THIS CON ARTIST..HE'S A SCAMMER",
    "author": "Edgar Batres",
    "rating": 1
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    "text": "",
    "author": "Pam Ryals",
    "rating": 5
  },
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    "date": "5 months ago",
    "text": "",
    "author": "Christian Velasquez",
    "rating": 5
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    "text": "",
    "author": "Lindsay Toothman",
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    "rating": 1
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    "text": "",
    "author": "IR",
    "rating": 1
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"pages_fetched": 2,
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"collection_cost": 0.182,
"escalation_reason": "NEGATIVE_SIGNAL_FOUND",
"serper_fraud_check": {
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  "signals": [
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    "POLARIZED_RATINGS"
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  "confidence": "HIGH"
}
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local_news

```

{
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OR site:fox4news.com",
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  "results": [
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      "title": "sitemap.xml",
      "snippet": "... pool-party-video-played-in-class/44977/</loc><lastmod>2017-
10-31T22:30:11+00 ... LLC, a Dairy Queen franchisee in Texas, New Mexico &
Oklahoma ...",
      "position": 1
    }
  ]
}

```

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conditions of the applicable policy documents for details. 4. Individual coverage limits apply. \$200 service call fee applies when the warranty claim is dispatched. 5. Membership rewards and perks include services that may be included in and/or benefits covered under the policy and may be provided by companies who have no affiliation with Porch Insurance and have sole financial responsibility for their products and services. 6. Terms and conditions: Subject to availability. Offer includes 2 movers for 2 hours scheduled in advance. Only available on new policies. Policy must be verified as bound or active within 60 days of its effective date. Must use within 90 days of policy issue date. Only one move per policy. You may add additional hours or movers, or book a same-day move, at your own cost. There is no cash alternative. Porch is not responsible for any additional costs and/or expenses in relation to the Offer. Non-transferable. Subject to HireAHelper terms at <https://www.porch.com/terms-and-conditions/#hah-terms/>. 7. Inspection report must be provided and reflect an inspection on the subject property within 3 years of the policy effective date by a licensed inspector. To maintain discount, inspection report must be provided every 3 years. Discount does not apply to premium for fire peril. Restrictions apply. See policy documents for full details. 8. With your first year of membership, you'll get four \$25 coupons to use toward Porch handyman services. Limit one coupon per appo

review_analysis

```
{
  "cost": 0.00071596000000000001,
  "summary": "The review profile is highly concerning. While some positive reviews exist, the negative reviews are numerous, detailed, and describe a severe, repeated pattern of taking deposits/full payment and then failing to complete work, becoming unresponsive, and delivering poor quality. The complete absence of middle-ground (3-4 star) reviews is a major red flag, indicating a business that either delights or severely disappoints, with strong evidence pointing towards unreliable and potentially fraudulent practices. The positive reviews, especially older ones, may be authentic past successes but do not outweigh the severe, recent allegations.",
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    "Generic praise in some 5-star reviews lacking specific details",
    "Owner name 'Joe Castro' appears in both positive and negative reviews, but negative reviews contain far more specific, credible allegations."
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    "Emotional authenticity in negative reviews (anger, betrayal)",
    "Some positive reviews mention specific projects (replaster, equipment install) and timelines",
    "Complaints show a consistent pattern of taking money and failing to complete work or provide adequate service."
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    "Allegations of theft/fraud"
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}

```

thumbtack

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tx_ag_complaints

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tx_sos_search

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website

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yelp_yahoo

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  "review_count": null  
}
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youtube

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then they form up ... How long does it take to build a pool in Florida so the way
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